

Pets and Property Alterations Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out DataCompany's approach to requests to keep pets at managed properties and to make alterations to those properties. Both activities require written consent from DataCompany and are subject to conditions designed to protect the property, maintain neighbourhood standards and ensure the comfort and safety of all residents.

2. Pets Policy

2.1 General Principle

DataCompany takes a positive approach to pet ownership and will not unreasonably withhold permission for tenants to keep suitable pets. Permission must be obtained in writing before any animal is brought onto or kept at the property. Keeping a pet without permission is a breach of the Tenancy Agreement.

2.2 Pets Requiring Permission

Pet Type	Permission Typically Granted?	Additional Conditions
Domestic cat	Yes (subject to property type)	Standard pet agreement required
Dog (small breed, under 10kg)	Yes (houses only; not flats without garden access)	Noise and nuisance assessment; additional cleaning deposit
Dog (medium to large breed)	Considered case by case	Breed restrictions apply; additional deposit required
Caged birds / budgerigars	Yes	Adequate ventilation must be maintained
Small caged animals (hamsters, rabbits)	Yes	Animals must be confined; no property damage permitted
Fish in aquarium	Yes (up to 100 litres)	Floor load-bearing capacity must be confirmed for larger tanks
Reptiles or exotic animals	Considered case by case	Requires specialist housing; insurance evidence required

Dogs on Zimbabwe Restricted Breeds List	No	Not permitted under any circumstances
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2.3 Pet Agreement Conditions

- All permitted dogs must be registered, vaccinated and microchipped in accordance with Harare City Council bylaws.
- Pets must not cause nuisance, noise disturbance or fear to neighbours or other residents.
- Tenants are responsible for any damage caused by their pets; repair costs will be recharged.
- A refundable pet deposit of USD 50 (cats and small dogs) or USD 100 (larger dogs) is payable prior to the pet being brought to the property.
- DataCompany may require a pet to be removed if it causes persistent nuisance or damage that the tenant fails to remedy after written warning.
- On vacating, the property must be professionally cleaned and flea-treated if a pet has been kept. Evidence of this treatment must be provided to DataCompany.

3. Property Alterations Policy

3.1 Alterations Requiring Prior Written Consent

- Any structural alteration, including removal of walls, installation of new partitions, creation of openings or alterations to doors and windows.
- Any changes to electrical wiring, consumer units or the addition of permanent electrical fixtures beyond standard fittings.
- Plumbing modifications including relocation of radiators, addition of sanitary ware or changes to waste pipe routing.
- Installation of satellite dishes, aerials or external communication equipment.
- Painting of external walls, doors or windows in colours other than those specified by DataCompany.
- Installation of fitted flooring including laminate, hardwood or ceramic floor tiles.
- Erection of garden structures such as sheds, greenhouses, raised beds or permanent fencing.
- Installation of security devices not provided by DataCompany, including locks and bars.

3.2 Minor Works Permitted Without Prior Consent

- Hanging pictures or lightweight mirrors using appropriate wall fixings (maximum 4 fixings per room).
- Applying removable adhesive-mounted items, providing no surface damage results.
- Installing curtain poles using provided or standard fixings at window locations.
- Replacing fuse wire or standard light bulbs and fluorescent tubes.

3.3 Alteration Request Process

Written requests for alterations must be submitted to property@datacompany.co.zw or via the tenant portal. Requests should include a description of the proposed work, the name of any contractor to be used, and a proposed start date. DataCompany will respond within 15 working days. Approval may be conditional on the use of a DataCompany-approved contractor, the submission of method statements, or additional deposit requirements.

3.4 Restoration Obligation

Unless DataCompany provides written confirmation that approved alterations may be retained, tenants are required to restore the property to its original condition at the end of the tenancy. The cost of restoration will be met by the tenant and will be deducted from the security deposit if not carried out prior to vacating.